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Review of the Prevalence and Incidence of ADHD in Canada

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The aim of this review was to examine the prevalence and incidence rates of ADHD in Canada. Eight papers were included that covered all provinces. Findings from this review indicate that:

- Based on one paper that examined people aged 1 to 24 years in Ontario, Quebec, Nova Scotia, and Manitoba, separately, the overall ADHD incidence rate in Canada is estimated at about 5.4%.
- Prevalence estimates for children and adolescents range from 0.5% (preschoolers)[6] to 8.57% (children and adolescents)[7]
- Prevalence estimates for adults range from 2.71%[8] to 7.33%[7]
- Estimates vary by gender, ranging from 3.7%[6] to 11.7%[13], in males and from 1.5%[6] to 7%[7] in females
- Prevalence is higher amongst children and adolescents than adults, both within individual provinces and across Canada.[7, 10, 13]
- Prevalence is higher amongst boys than girls across the lifespan, but that this disparity may decrease with age.[6, 12-13]

Source: https://www.caddra.ca/wp-content/uploads/Research-Digest_Dec-2021_FINAL.pdf